

Newsmaker 2008: The Terrorist

JANUARY 5, 2009

The force of his bloodlust has made India the most scalded victim of radical Islam. The sweep of his savagery has at last prompted us to recognise the enormity of the threat we face as a nation under attack.



“Terrorists are perpetrators of hatred who have been misguided by fundamentalists to adopt this path of violence. Their undying hatred and pursuit of paradise has made this earth a hell.”

AMITABH KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

Tactical Terror

Isn't it ironical that a land which is heir to Mahatma Gandhi's legacy of non-violence and peace can allow itself to wallow in so much violence and destruction and that the faceless terrorist was the biggest newsmaker of the year ("The Terrorist", January 5)? The fanatically poised terrorist should know that killing innocent people for religion is akin to lying for honesty.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Last year was indeed full of surprises. The highs—India's successful moon mission, Viswanathan Anand's chess victory, Abhinav Bindra, Vijender Singh and Akhil Kumar's Olympic glory, Akshay Kumar's tri-



Moolah Rules

The gruesome murder of engineer Manoj Gupta clearly shows the level our politicians can stoop to for self-aggrandisement ("Birthday Bash-Up", January 5). Now, Mayawati has a lot of answering to do. The law must take its course and punish the guilty.

VIRENDRA TANGRI, via www.indiatoday.in

Mayawati's birthday is one of many occasions when she asks people to contribute openly. She should be forced to issue instructions to stop such illegal activities forthwith and return all the money collected so far.

D.B.N. MURTHY, via www.indiatoday.in

umphant strides at the box-office, the launch of Ratan Tata's promising common man's car—were, however, no match to the lows—the cash-for-votes scandal that rocked Parliament during the trust vote, horrifying terror attacks across various cities and the unpredictable Sensex. A mixed bag which taught us an important lesson: "Yes, we can, if and only if we want to." And all of us should come together to defeat those who are waging a war against us and give them a befitting reply for attacking our unity, integrity and sovereignty.

SHYAM SINGH,
via www.indiatoday.in

Politically Right

"To err is human" is all that Prime Minister Manmohan Singh could